A 03-09

GENERAL INFORMATION ON THE ACCREDITATION PROCESS

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1. Purpose and Scope

The purpose of this document is to provide the necessary information on the SANAS accreditation and assessment process required to apply for SANAS accreditation. This document should be read in conjunction with the programme specific procedures on the accreditation process, available on the SANAS website, prior to submitting a formal application for accreditation.

This document is applicable to all areas of accreditation covered by SANAS, i.e.:

- Testing, Calibration, Medical, Veterinary, Pharmaceutical, Forensics, Verification Laboratories / Repair Bodies and Blood Transfusion Services;
- Certification and Inspection Bodies;
- B-BBEE Rating Agencies;
- Proficiency Testing Providers;
- Reference Material Producers;
- Good Laboratory Practice (GLP) and Good Clinical Practice (GCP)

2. Definitions and References

PM 01	SANAS Policy Manual
A 01	References, Acronyms and Definitions
P 04	Accreditation of Laboratories, Proficiency Testing Scheme Providers and Reference Material Producers
P 05	The Assessment of Certification Bodies
P 07	Management of Impartiality
P 12	Handling of Complaints and Appeals
P 14	SANAS Fees
P 15	Accreditation of Inspection Bodies. Regulatory and Voluntary Domain
P 16	OECD Good Laboratory Practice (GLP) Compliance Monitoring Programme
P 17	Accreditation of Verification Laboratories / Repair Bodies
P 19	Terms of Reference, Registration and Responsibilities of Specialist Technical Committees
P 20	The Responsibilities and Duties of the Approval Committees and Accreditation Managers in the Approval and Decision on Accreditation
P 24	Accreditation of B-BBEE Rating Agencies
P 32	Transition to New Standards
P 35	Remote Assessments – Management and Execution
P 37	Management of Extraordinary Events or Circumstances and Conditions for Terminating Assessments
P 41	Sampling for Assessment Purposes
P 43	Procedure for the Development and Extending of Accreditation Schemes

3. Accreditation

SANAS accreditation is the official recognition that a Conformity Assessment Body (CAB) is competent to perform specific tasks and has a documented Management System in place to ensure consistent implementation of its processes. An accredited CAB will have demonstrated through formal assessment that it is competent to perform the specific tasks for which accreditation is sought. In addition, the CAB needs to demonstrate that it satisfies both national and international criteria in this respect. The requirements that have to be complied with for the various CABs are given in the SANAS documents relevant to the scope of accreditation.

3.1 GLP Compliance Monitoring

Compliance monitoring is a regular inspection of test CABs and studies by a Monitoring Authority (SANAS) in order to evaluate the degree of conformity with OECD Principles of Good Laboratory Practice (GLP) and to determine the integrity of data to assure that resulting data are of adequate quality for assessment and decision making by Regulatory Authorities. These inspections result in reports which describe the degree of adherence of a test CAB to the GLP Principles. The

requirements that must be complied with are stated in the SANAS P16 document and OECD series on Principles of Good laboratory Practice available on the OECD website.

Note: All ISO/IEC and National documents and standards are available from *the South African Bureau of Standards* (SABS). All IAF guidance and mandatory documents are freely available from the IAF web site www.iaf.nu and ILAC guidance from the ILAC web site www.ilac.org. SANAS documents are available from the SANAS web site www.sanas.co.za . OECD documents are freely available from the OECD website www.oecd.org.

4. Scope of Accreditation

Every accredited / compliant CAB is issued with a certificate and scope of accreditation detailing the scope of activities and functions which satisfy all the necessary accreditation / GLP compliance requirements and for which accreditation / compliance is granted.

Applicants are required to complete the relevant on-line application form, available on the SANAS website at www.sanas.co.za, and provide detailed information on the scope for which accreditation is being sought. If any problems are experienced the applicant should contact the SANAS office for further guidance.

The draft scope of accreditation will be confirmed with the applicant during the initial assessment and will only be issued once accreditation has been granted.

Where applicable, applicants who opt to undergo a pre-assessment visit should discuss the scope of accreditation with the assessor / inspector and try to finalise it as far as possible prior to the initial assessment / inspection.

No CAB is permitted to use the SANAS accreditation / GLP compliance symbol until such time that they have received written confirmation from SANAS that they have been accredited or are GLP compliant.

An accredited / GLP compliant organisation should consult SANAS document R 04 “Conditions for use of the Accreditation symbols, reference to accreditation and combined marks”, prior to preparing any organisational material, which makes any reference to accreditation / GLP compliance or incorporates the SANAS accreditation symbol.

5. General Application Information

The accreditation / GLP compliance process and approximate timelines are described in Appendix A.

For accreditation or very general enquiries the program-specific SANAS brochures published on the SANAS website at www.sanas.co.za may be sufficient to enable the client to gain the information required.

For more detailed information, the following documentation should be consulted, and is also available on the SANAS website:

- PM 01 “SANAS Policy manual”
- F 147 “Terms and Conditions of Accreditation”, or F 199 “Terms and Conditions of GLP or GCP Compliance”, as applicable.
- P 14 “SANAS Fees”
- R 03 “Nominated Representative and Signatories: Responsibilities, Qualifications and Approval”
- The applicable programme-specific document:
    - P 04 “Accreditation of Laboratories and Proficiency Testing Scheme Providers and Reference Material Producers”
    - P 05 “The Assessment of Certification Bodies”
    - P 16 “Good Laboratory Practice (GLP) Compliance Monitoring Program”
    - P 24 “Accreditation of B-BBEE Rating Agencies”
    - P 15 “Accreditation of Inspection Bodies”

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- P 17 "Accreditation of Verification Laboratories / Repair Bodies. Regulatory and Voluntary Domain."

- P 12 "Handling of Complaints and Appeals"
- P 26 "Cross Frontier Accreditation"
- P 35 Remote Assessments – Management and Execution

- Latest SANAS Annual Reports and News
- Information on SANAS Training Courses and Dates are available on the SANAS website

6. Scopes of Accreditation Offered by SANAS

The Table below outlines the scopes of accreditation that is offered by SANAS and indicates the International or National Standards that must be complied with in order to be accredited.

Accreditation Scheme (SANAS Document)	***Accreditation Standard***	***Voluntary or Regulatory Domain***	***Covered by:***	***Accreditation is granted for:***
Testing Laboratories (P04)	ISO/IEC 17025	Voluntary & Regulatory	ILAC, AFRAC & SADCA MRA	• Tests performed on specified materials or products to specified test methods; • Techniques - for specified instrument(s) using specific chemical and / or physical methods, to identify and / or determine a physical property of a material or species contained within.
Medical Testing Laboratories (P04)	ISO 15189	Voluntary	ILAC & AFRAC MRA	• Tests performed on human biological materials to specified test methods.
Calibration Laboratories (P04)	ISO/IEC 17025	Voluntary	ILAC, AFRAC & SADCA MRA	• Specified types of measurements performed, measurement range and calibration and measurement capability (CMC). • The transfer of traceability from national standards.
GLP / GCP Facilities (P16)	OECD Principles of GLP / VICH Principles of GCP	Voluntary	OECD	• GLP compliance monitoring, according to the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) Principles of Good Laboratory Practice for facilities conducting non-clinical environmental health and safety studies
Blood Transfusion Services (P04)	ISO 15189	Voluntary	ILAC & AFRAC MRA	Registration, collection, testing, processing and storage of blood for human transfusion purposes
Proficiency Testing (PT) Providers (P04)	ISO/IEC 17043	Voluntary	ILAC & AFRAC MRA	• The development and operation of PT schemes
Reference Material Producers (RMP) (P04)	ISO 17034	Voluntary	ILAC & AFRAC MRA	• The planning, production, authorisation and assignment of property values of RMP

Accreditation Scheme (SANAS Document)	***Accreditation Standard***	***Voluntary or Regulatory Domain***	***Covered by:***	***Accreditation is granted for:***
Inspection Bodies (P15)	• ISO/IEC17020 and/or the National Standards specific to the field of inspection	Voluntary / Regulatory	ILAC & AFRAC MRA or National Programme as applicable	The performance of inspections in a specified field, e.g.: Gas Test Station; Major Hazard Installation; Food Inspection; Textiles, Clothing, Leather and Footwear; PER – Manufacturing; PER – In-service; Legal Metrology Inspection; Explosives; Electrical Inspection (Regulation R242); Gaming and Gambling; X-Ray Equipment; Automotive Inspection; Electrotechnical (NRCS); Energy Efficiency (M&V); Occupational Hygiene Inspection; Lift Inspection; Abattoir Inspection; Steel Structure Inspection; Fire Detection and Prevention; Energy Performance Certificates for Buildings.
Verification and Repair Bodies (P17)	LM-045-09-19 & NRCS requirements	Regulatory	National Programme	Verification of measurement instruments used for trade. Note: Laboratories assessed to LM-045-09-19 are not allowed to perform commercial calibrations to ISO/IEC 17025 unless their accreditation certificate specifically indicates they are accredited for this. The Regulator recognised this exclusion.
Broad Based Black Economic Empowerment (B-BBEE) Verification (P24)	SANAS R47 and relevant Sector Codes of Good Practice	Regulatory	National programme	Accreditation is granted for B-BBEE Rating Agencies verifying an organisation's compliance to the B-BBEE Codes and the Sector Codes

Certification Accreditation Schemes (SANAS Document P05)	***Accreditation Standard (Level 3)***	***Voluntary or Regulatory Domain***	***Covered by:***	***Sub-scopes (Levels 4 and 5):***
Management System Certification	ISO/IEC 17021-1 and IAF mandatory documents, as applicable	Voluntary	IAF MLA and/or AFRAC MRA, and SADCA MRA	• Quality Management Systems (QMS) to ISO 9001. • Environmental Management Systems (EMS) to ISO 50001 • Food Safety Management System (FSMS) to ISO 22003-1 • Energy Management Systems (EnMS) certified to ISO 50001 • Food Safety System Certification (FSSC): FSSC 22000 • Medical Devices Quality Management Systems (MDQMS) to ISO 13485 • Occupational Health and Safety System (OH&SMS) to ISO 45001

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			National or International Programme	• Fusion welding of metallic materials to SANS 3834 • Hazards Critical Control Points (HACCP) to SANS10330. • Information Security Management System (ISMS) and ISO/IEC 27006 • Information Technology Service Management System (ITSMS) and ISO/IEC 20000-1 • Responsible Tourism certified to SANS 1162 • Risk Based Inspection (RBI) - Specific standards in SANS 347 (ASME; API) • Road Transport Management Systems to SANS 1395-1 • Business Incubators & Accelerators requirements to SATS 2234 • Asset Management Systems ISO 55001
Certification of persons	ISO/IEC 17024 and IAF Mandatory documents	Voluntary	IAF MLA and AFRAC MRA	• As per relevant scheme rules
Product Certification	ISO/IEC 17065, and any relevant IAF mandatory documents	Voluntary	IAF MLA, AFRAC MRA and National Programme	- GLOBALGAP: Integrated Farm Assurance (IFA) General Regulations: GLOBALG.A.P IFA Control Points and Compliance Criteria (Option 1, 2 or 3) - Organic agriculture production and processing to SANS 1369 - Scheme rules/requirements established by the scheme owner including methods of measuring and identifying conformity (refer to ISO 17067) and National/International product/process/service specifications used to establish conformity of the defined commodity to be certified
Greenhouse gas Validation & Verification	ISO/IEC 17029; ISO 14065 and IAF mandatory documents, where applicable	Voluntary	Not yet signatory to IAF	Greenhouse gases (GHG) to ISO 14064-3; ISO 14066, ISO 14064-1 & ISO 14064-2

7. Application Information

7.1 The following is a brief outline of the accreditation process and documents needed:

7.1.1 The applicant writes and implements a management system based on the applicable accreditation standard (The standards are obtainable from the local standards body).

7.1.2 An authorised representative of the applicant applies for accreditation / GLP or GCP compliance by completing all sections of the relevant on-line application form which is available on the SANAS website as www.sanas.co.za. The application requires very comprehensive information on the applicant's organisation. This information is necessary to allow SANAS to judge the extent to which the organisation's documented Management System satisfies the SANAS accreditation requirements.

7.1.3 The application form must be submitted with the Management System (Quality) Manual and supporting information / documentation as required in the application, and which must include information demonstrating that the requirements of the relevant international standard are addressed.

Note 1: If there are any challenges in submitting this information, please contact the SANAS office at (012) 740 8400.

Note 2: An organisation may submit a completed application form for the sole purpose of obtaining a detailed quotation. However, the application will not be processed further than the quotation stage without the submission of the supporting documentation and application fee.

7.1.4 The signing / acceptance of the Application Declaration form on-line binds the applicant to the SANAS F 147 "Terms and Conditions of Accreditation" or F 199 "Terms and Conditions of GLP or GCP Compliance", as applicable, which are available on the SANAS website.

Note: CABs are advised to read the relevant SANAS documents for their scope of application as well as the SANAS Terms and Conditions for accreditation / GLP or GCP compliance prior to completing and submitting the SANAS application form.

7.1.5 SANAS will review the completeness and suitability of the application and all information submitted and clarify all outstanding issues with the applicant before proceeding to the next step. This review is done to determine whether the application criteria have been met, whether SANAS offers the scope of accreditation applied for and is able to carry out the assessment.

Note: *Failure to complete and submit all the required supporting information and documentation may result in a delay in processing the application.*

7.1.6 SANAS quotes and invoices the CAB for the application fee as per SANAS Fees documents (P 14). The fee covers the costs of the application and document review. Acceptance and payment of the invoice is required before proceeding to the next stage of the assessment process.

7.1.7 A SANAS assessment team consisting of a Team Leader and Technical Assessors / Experts to cover the scope of the application is appointed. The names of the proposed assessment team members and the organisations they work for are provided to the CAB.

7.1.8 The CAB may object to the appointment of any members of the team if a conflict of interest exists.. On acceptance of the team by the CAB, the team will evaluate the Management System Manual / documentation to determine whether the CAB's management system complies with the relevant accreditation standard, applicable regulatory requirements and any other requirements for accreditation.

7.1.8 The applicant is provided with a document review report within 4 weeks of receiving the completed application and documentation and application fee. The report contains comments on any deficiencies / omissions and a recommendation on the way forward. If the recommendation is not to proceed with an assessment, clear justification will be provided. The CAB will be provided with an opportunity to correct any deficiencies noted in the report before an on-site assessment can be scheduled. The period to correct deficiencies should not exceed 6 months.

7.1.9 Once the Management System Manual satisfactorily addresses all the requirements of the applicable accreditation standard, the relevant Accreditation Manager prepares a quote and the CAB is invoiced for a pre-assessment or initial assessment / GLP inspection, as applicable. On receipt of payment, a pre-assessment / initial assessment / inspection date is arranged.

7.1.10 The Pre-assessment

i) A Pre-assessment visit may be requested by an applicant in the voluntary domain or may be required after review of the applicants' documents.

ii) A pre-assessment is compulsory for CABs operating in the regulatory domain and is conducted to give the regulator confidence that the applicant has a management system in place, thus allowing the regulator to grant the applicant a temporary

approval to entrench the system and build sufficient technical evidence to allow for a full technical evaluation of the applicants' facility.

iii) The pre-assessment is a site visit normally carried out by the appointed Team Leader within 1 day. At the end of the assessment, the Team Leader will supply the CAB with at least a recommendation report and if applicable, non-conformances. In addition, CABs in the regulatory domain will also receive the completed checklist and a draft certificate and scope of accreditation from the Team leader.

iv) The CAB may need to make changes to its policies, procedures and practices prior to SANAS undertaking the initial assessment. The CAB is responsible to inform SANAS when they have addressed all the findings and are ready for the initial assessment.

v) CABs in the regulatory domain are required to provide SANAS with evidence of corrective action taken for any non-conformances identified. Once all the findings raised during the pre-assessment have been effectively cleared, SANAS will award the CAB with a Letter of Acknowledgement in order for the CAB to apply to the relevant Government Department / Regulator for provisional approval to operate. This approval will be subjected to the CAB obtaining SANAS accreditation within 6 months. The CAB must provide SANAS with a copy of the approval certificate they obtained from the Government Department/Regulator, in order for SANAS to proceed with the initial assessment.

7.1.11 The Initial Assessment

i) The CAB must ensure that there are sufficient (at least 3 months) records to confirm that the system is implemented prior to the initial assessment / inspection visit. SANAS requires that a complete internal audit and management review be conducted by the applicant prior to the assessment / inspection visit.

ii) An initial assessment is a comprehensive site visit carried out by the Team Leader and the appropriate number of technical assessors with the required expertise for the scope of accreditation applied for, normally within 2 days. The programme specific P-documents describe the assessment process in detail.

iii) The CAB will be required to submit to SANAS evidence of corrective action for any non-conformances identified during the initial assessment within 3 months from the date of the initial assessment.

iv) Once all non-conformances recorded at the assessment / inspection have been satisfactorily cleared, the assessment documentation is submitted to the SANAS Approval Committee, who decides on whether accreditation can be granted.

v) Once a CAB is accredited, SANAS will provide the CAB with a Certificate and Scope of Accreditation, valid for a specified period. The Certificate and Scope of Accreditation will be published on the SANAS website. Once accredited, the CAB can use the SANAS accreditation symbol on their reports containing accredited results.

7.1.12 After accreditation has been obtained, SANAS will confirm that the CAB continues to comply with accreditation requirements by carrying out regular on-site surveillance visits at specified intervals. SANAS will sample the scope of accreditation during these visits in line with the P41 "Sampling for Assessment Purposes".

8. Application for Extension of Scope / Approval of Personnel

8.1. Applications for Extension of the Accreditation scope applies to CABs which:

- Have already been accredited, where the CAB wishes to extend the accredited scope of tests / inspections / certifications within the existing accredited field.
- Where an already accredited CAB wishes to apply for accreditation in a new scope altogether, but under the same management system.

The following procedure shall apply for extension of accreditation scope:

The CAB is required to complete the relevant sections of the on-line application form together with the supporting information / documentation as required in the application and submit it to SANAS at least 6 weeks before the next scheduled assessment.

8.2. CABs wishing to add a new technical signatory or nominated representative to the Certificate and Scope of Accreditation, must complete the relevant sections of the on-line application form at least 6 weeks before the next scheduled assessment. (This does not apply to Medical Laboratories).

8.3 Where possible, assessment or witnessing of extensions for accreditation or approval of personnel will be carried out at the next surveillance or re-assessment visit, however, when requested by the CAB, or required by SANAS based on the evaluation of the application, additional visits will be arranged. Pro-rata fees will be invoiced for additional visits and annual fees will be adjusted to accommodate the cost associated with the changes.

8.4 Applications for extension of scope or approval of personnel may not require a full review of the quality manual.

8.5 On receipt of payment, an assessment date is arranged. The CAB must ensure that there are sufficient records for the scope of extension to confirm that the system is implemented prior to the assessment visit.

8.6 The assessment is conducted on site by the Team Leader and/or technical assessor/s. The names of the assessment team member(s) are made known to the CAB prior to the planned visit, to allow the CAB to object to members of the team, with good reason.

8.7 Once all non-conformances recorded at the assessment are cleared, the Approval Committee may grant or decline the extension and/or approval of the signatory/ Nominated Representative, based on the outcome of the assessment.

9. Application for Renewal of Accreditation: Re-assessment

9.1. Accredited CABs are required to apply for renewal of accreditation 6 months prior to, and in the case of Inspection Bodies, 9 months prior to the expiry date of the Certificate of Accreditation. All sections of the relevant application form must be completed.

9.2 The application form must be accompanied by the fully completed Management & Technical checklists containing comments on how the requirements of the relevant standard are implemented and in which policy / procedure it is addressed. SANAS may request other information as needed.

9.3 On receipt of the application and supporting documentation, SANAS will arrange a re-assessment approximately 3 months prior, and in the case of Inspection Bodies, 6 months prior to the expiry date of the Certificate of Accreditation. Information gathered from assessments performed over the accreditation cycle will be taken into consideration when planning the re-assessment.

9.4 The application information will be submitted to the Assessment Team once they are appointed, in order to allow the team to prepare for the assessment and request any further information / clarifications before the assessment. Feedback on information need not be provided, unless there are concerns about the information provided, and where the CAB is required to take action.

9.5 The reassessment will confirm the competence of the CAB and cover all the requirements of the standard(s) for which the CAB is accredited. The CAB will be required to submit evidence of

corrective actions to SANAS for any non-conformances identified within 25 working days of the re-assessment.

9.6 Once all, if any, non-conformances have been satisfactorily cleared by the assessors, SANAS will arrange for the Approval Committee to review the assessment information and decide on the renewal of accreditation.

9.7 On successful renewal of accreditation, SANAS will provide the CAB with a new Certificate and Scope of Accreditation valid for a specified period.

10. Confidentiality

All information submitted to SANAS in support of the application shall be treated in confidence. All assessors used by SANAS are required to sign the SANAS Assessor Contract, as well as confidentiality agreements prior to each assessment they perform. Any breach of confidentiality will be viewed in a very serious manner. SANAS will request written permission from all accredited CABs or applicants prior to releasing any information to a third party, such as information that SANAS is required to release by law or authorised by contractual arrangements to do so)

11. Time-scale for the Accreditation Process

11.1 SANAS makes every effort to ensure that all applications are processed as efficiently as possible. The time taken to process an application depends on a number of factors, some of which are outside the control of SANAS. The timing is dependent on:

i) Payment of application and assessment fees;
ii) The quality of the applicant's documentation and the extent to which it complies with SANAS and accreditation requirements. A delay can occur due to insufficient documented procedures and submission of inadequate Management System Manuals and/or completed checklists;
ii) The availability of suitable assessors and resources within SANAS;
iii) The level of implementation of the system and availability of evidence of the technical competence; and/or
iv) How efficiently the applicant clears the non-conformances after the initial assessment.

11.2 Generally, accreditation takes between 3 - 6 months from receipt of the completed application form with all the prerequisite information, to the initial assessment. Refer to Appendix A for an indication of the specific time expectations for each stage of the application process.

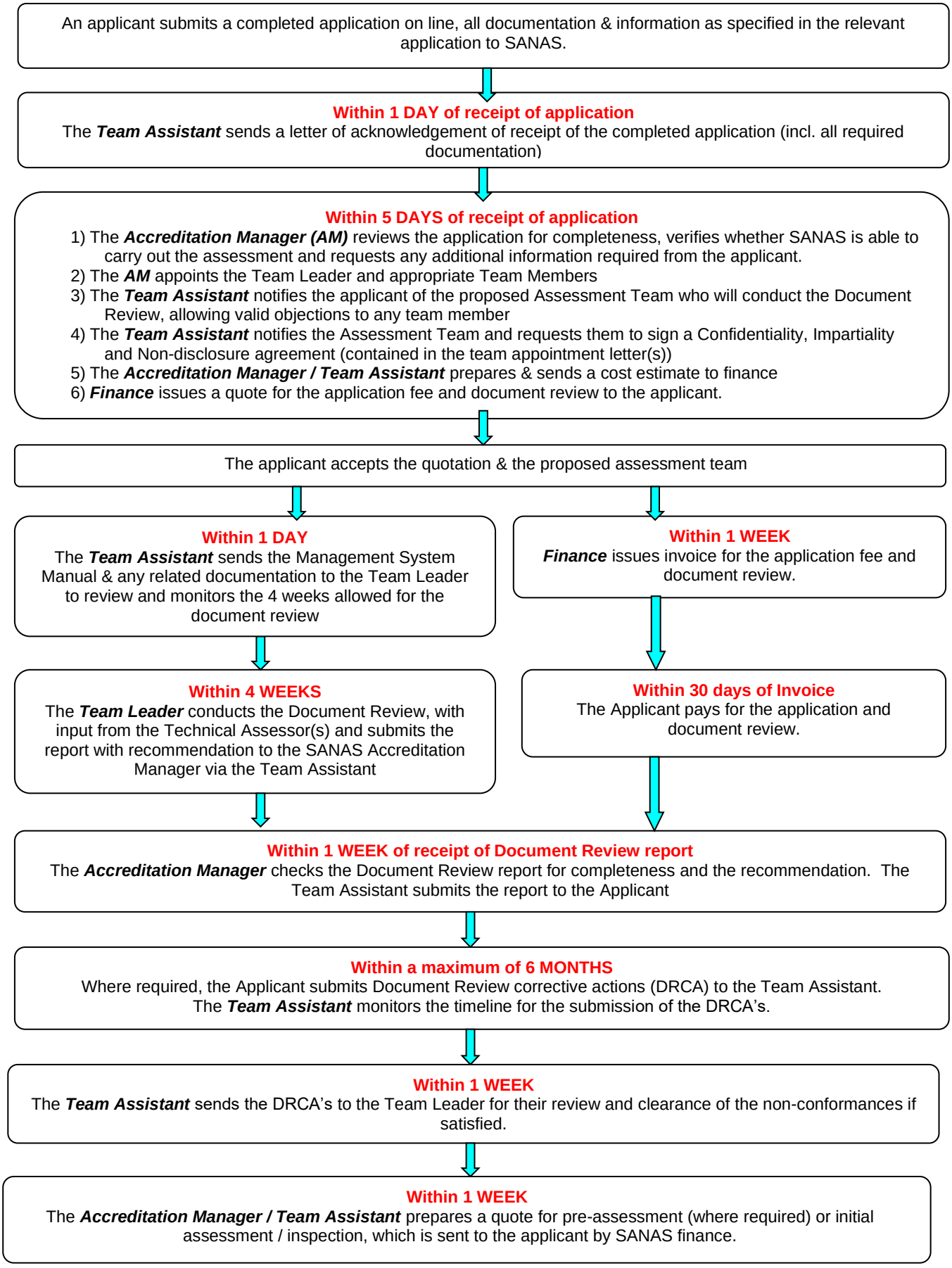
11.3 An application that has not proceeded to the initial assessment stage within 1 year from the date of application will lapse, in exceptional circumstances, such as times of national disaster this period may be extended at the discretion of SANAS. Unless otherwise agreed with SANAS, this may result in the applicant having to re-apply for accreditation. All application fees will be applied for the re-application.

12. Scope of Accreditation

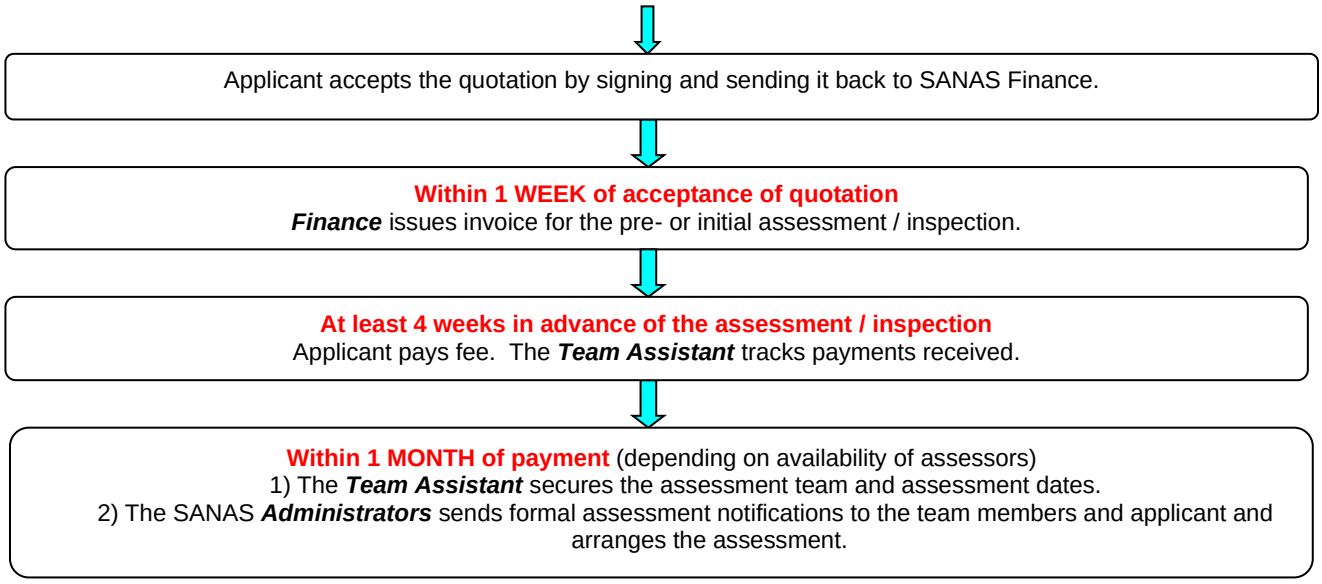
12.1 It is SANAS' policy to define the scope of an CAB's accreditation as precisely as possible. CABs are therefore required to specify in detail the information of conformity assessment activity for which accreditation is sought and the locations at which these activities are to be carried out. This scope will be agreed upon as far as possible before the assessment in order to determine the extent of the assessment activities. Following successful assessment, the scope, including standard specifications / methods / procedures relevant to the testing/calibration/proficiency testing/production of reference materials concerned will be identified on the scope of accreditation.

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Appendix A: Approximate Timeframe for the Accreditation Process / GLP Monitoring Process



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Appendix B: The Accreditation Process

The following table will be the format of the Accreditation Process; procedures are in place to describe the specific requirements for the various accreditation programs with the necessary responsibilities included.

The Application Process	
Application for Accreditation	• The application criteria and process is described in the programme specific documents (P04, P05, P15, P16; P17 and P24). Applicants will be required to make a formal application on the relevant on-line Application form, which will include a list of the information required. • SANAS will review each application in order to ensure that the application criteria have been met and that SANAS has the necessary resources and competence in order to conduct the assessment.
Initial Assessment Process	
Preparation for Assessment	• The applicant's documents will be reviewed by an appointed Assessment Team, if deficiencies are identified, the CAB will be required to correct these deficiencies prior to the initial assessment. • Pre-assessment visits may be requested in the voluntary arena, where deficiencies in the system may be identified. • Pre-assessments will be carried out in the regulatory domain.
Allocation of the Assessment Team	• An assessment team will be appointed, which will include a Team Leader and the required number of technical assessors with the appropriate expertise for each specific scope.
Initial Assessment	• The assessment team will conduct an assessment in accordance with SANAS procedures at the applicants' Head Office and all other premises of the CAB from which key activities are performed, and which are covered by the scope of accreditation. • The applicant CAB must satisfy the SANAS assessors that it complies with all relevant ISO/IEC Standard/Guide and any International interpretation thereof, and SANAS accreditation requirements to enable the assessment team to make a positive recommendation to the Approval Committee (AC). • CABs that wish to be accredited for on-site activities shall, where relevant, comply with the

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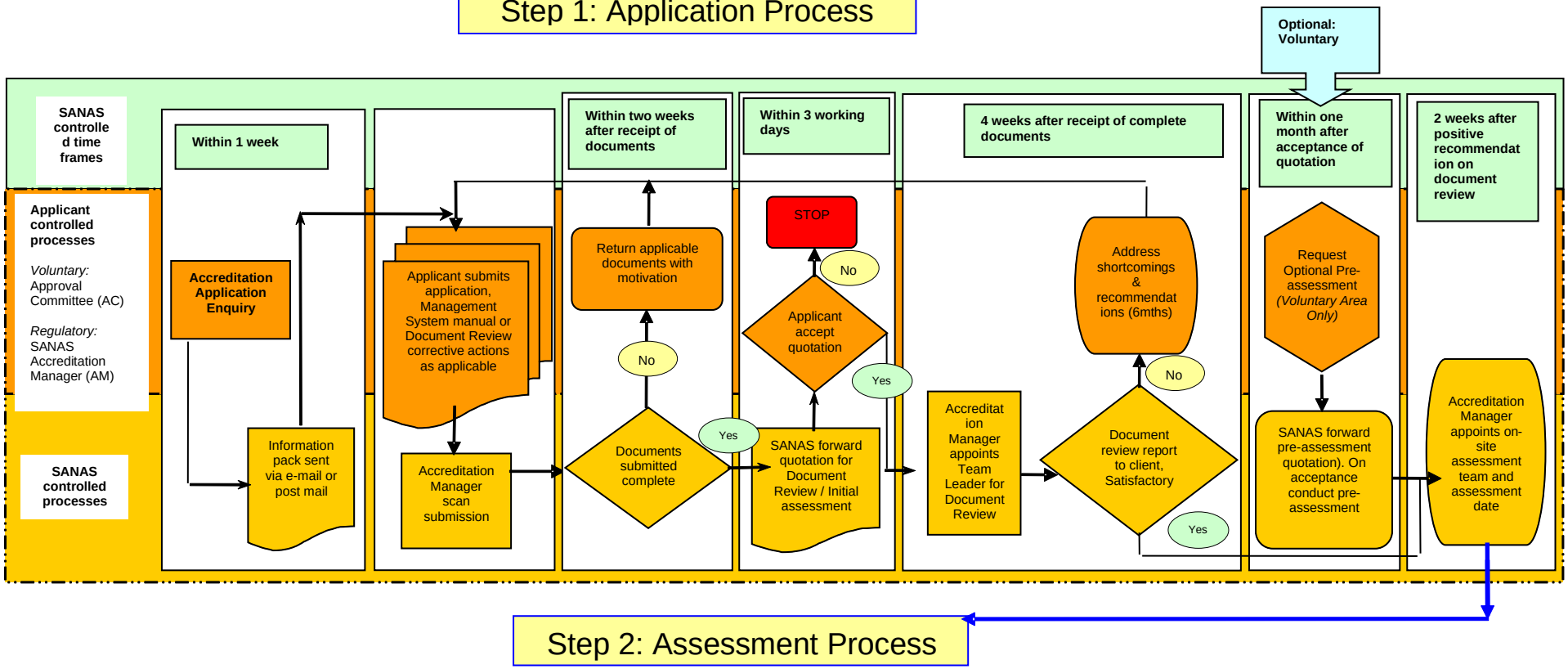
	additional requirements that may be applicable for that specific field. Additional criteria for on-site accreditation are given in SANAS Requirement or Technical Requirement documents where such additional requirements exist.
The Decision-making process	The AC evaluates the adequacy of information provided by the assessment team, and determines, based on the information gathered, submitted and the recommendation made by the assessment team, whether requirements for accreditation have been fulfilled, and whether accreditation can be granted. (Refer to P20 for procedures of the Approval Committee)
Issue of Certificate and Scope of Accreditation	• If accreditation is granted by SANAS, an accreditation certificate signed by the CEO, with a Scope detailing the scope of accreditation signed by the relevant Accreditation Manager will be issued to the CAB. • Accreditation will remain valid as long as the organisation continues to comply with SANAS requirements. All certificates will be issued with a validity date, subject to changes which can impact the CAB's status. (E.g. change to scope of accreditation, range of measurements / tests or changes in location, phone number, senior staff, etc.) • Refer to P10 "Accreditation / GLP Compliance Certificate", which describes the format and procedures for the issue and maintenance of Certificates and Scopes of Accreditation.
Continued Compliance with accreditation and SANAS requirements	• It will be responsibility of the accredited CAB to ensure that it complies with all accreditation criteria, as well as the Terms and Conditions of Accreditation at all times. The accredited CAB will be required to report any possible non-compliance with criteria to SANAS immediately. Should an accredited CAB fail to continue to comply with accreditation criteria at any time before the expiry of the certificate the accreditation shall be withdrawn by SANAS. Once withdrawn the accredited CAB shall comply with all requirements in terms of the conditions of the withdrawal. Note: The GLP compliance monitoring process is fully described in the document P16 "Good Laboratory Practice (GLP) Compliance Monitoring Program".
Maintenance of Accreditation	
6-month follow-up Assessment	• SANAS will verify continued compliance/competence by conducting follow-up visits to all newly accredited CABs approximately 6 - 12 months after the date of initial accreditation. This will normally be undertaken by the Team Leader unless otherwise delegated by the Accreditation Manager.
Surveillance Assessments	• Surveillance assessments will be scheduled from 12 to no longer than 24-month intervals. (Refer to the program-specific P-documents) • Surveillance visits will follow the initial assessment format but on a sampling basis (Refer to SANAS P 41 "Sampling for Assessment Purposes"). Each surveillance visit will involve a technical assessment of the CAB together with an assessment of the Quality Management System. • The program specific P-documents (P04, P05, P15, P16; P17 and P24) detail the surveillance assessment process and intervals of the assessments. • All Technical Signatories must be available at each assessment. SANAS will assess each technical signatory at least once in an accreditation cycle the selection of who will be assessed will be made by SANAS.
Re-assessments	• On successful application for renewal of accreditation by the CAB, re-assessments will be arranged for approximately 3 months prior to the expiry date of the Certificate of Accreditation, and in the case of Inspection Bodies, 6 months prior to the expiry date of the Certificate of Accreditation (Refer to Table 2 for the Validity period of certificates) • Information gathered from assessments performed over the accreditation cycle will be taken into consideration when planning the re-assessment. • The next cycle will begin with assessments carried out at 12-month to no longer than 24-month intervals, depending on the length of the accreditation cycle. SANAS can unilaterally make changes to the assessment interval at any stage of the process, but intervals will not be longer than 24 months; • Re-assessment visits will confirm the competence of the CAB and cover all the requirements of the standard(s) for which the Cab is accredited. (Refer to SANAS P 41 "Sampling for Assessment Purposes").

	• The decision-making process and re-issue of the Certificate and Scope of Accreditation will follow the Re-assessment, as for the initial assessment.
Extension of Accreditation	• Extensions of accreditation will follow the same process as for initial accreditation. • Applications for extension shall be made at least six (6) weeks prior to the on-site visit. • P05 “The Assessment of Certification Bodies” will include procedures for extension(s) in the product certification field for specification addition in an existing accredited EAC code.
Personnel Evaluations	• SANAS document R03 defines the requirements for the Responsibilities, Qualifications and Approval of Nominated Representatives and Signatories. As part of the assessment, the SANAS team will assess the competence of personnel in the performance of their functions and in their understanding and implementation of SANAS’ requirements. Approval of personnel as signatories or Nominated Representatives will follow the decision-making process as defined above.

NOTE: The timescale for the accreditation / GLP compliance monitoring process is approximate and depends on the completeness of the application documentation, the Document Review report, correction of non-conformances (where relevant, the payment of fees, the submission of the signed Accreditation agreement and the availability of the relevant staff.

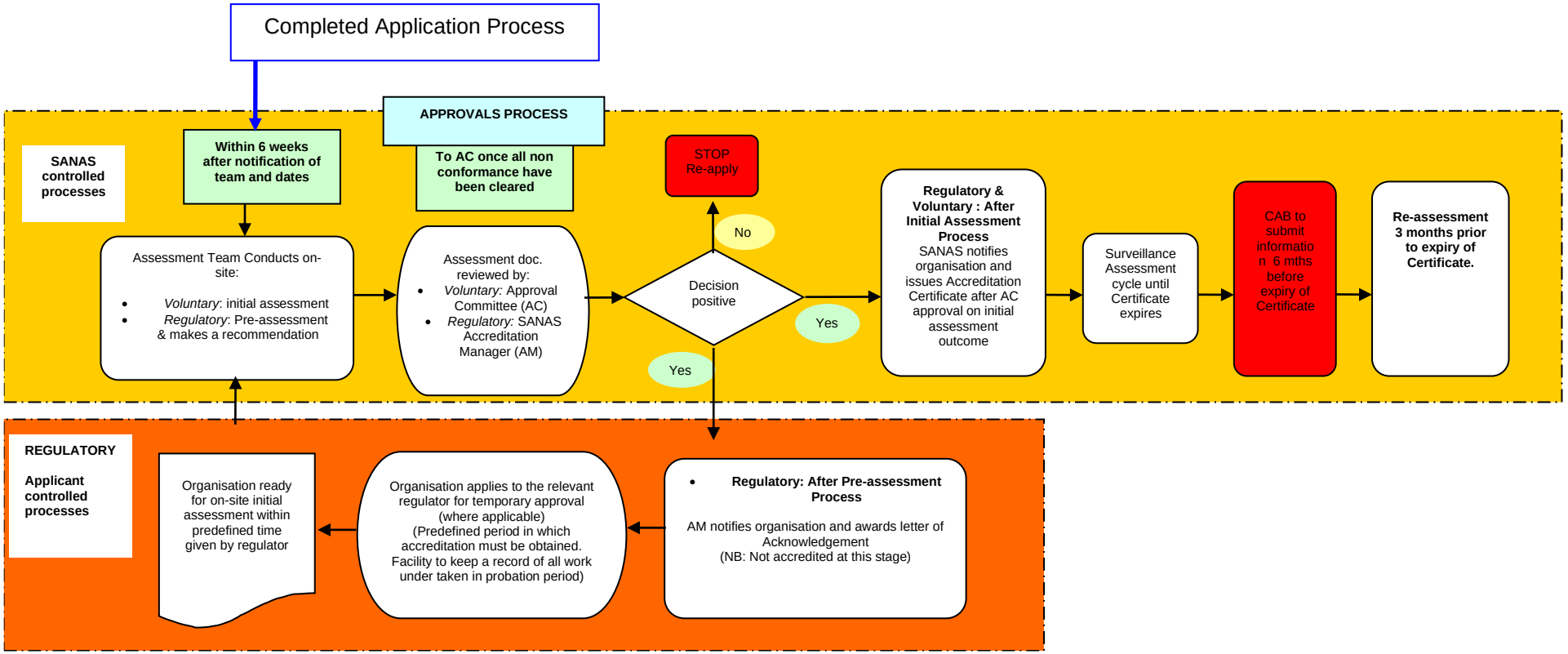
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Step 1: Application Process



Step 2: Assessment Process

Step 2: Assessment Process



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Appendix C: Amendment Record

Proposed By:	Section	Change
		"Accreditation of Laboratories, Proficiency Testing Scheme Providers and Reference Material Producers"
QM	1.	All bullets deleted "Accreditation of" Last bullet deleted "Compliance monitoring of...CABs"
QM	6.	Complete rewrite of the table
QM	7.1.2	Added "on-line"
QM	7.1.4	Added "on-line" Deleted "Terms and Conditions of Accreditation."
QM	7.1.5	Added "completeness and suitability of the"
QM	7.1.6	Added "The fee covers the costs of the application and document review. Acceptance and payment of the invoice is required before proceeding to the next stage of the assessment process."
QM	7.1.7	Changes from "…is appointed, the names of which are known…" to "… consisting of a Team Leader and Technical Assessors / Experts to cover the scope of the application…The names of the proposed assessment team members and the organisations they work for are provided…"
QM	7.1.8	Changes from "…with the results of the…and a recommendation…" to "…a…report within 4 weeks of receiving the completed application and documentation and application fee. The report contains comments on any deficiencies / omissions and a recommendation…. If the recommendation is not to proceed with an assessment, clear justification will be provided."
QM	7.1.10 iii)	Deleted "completed…reports" Added "In addition, CABs in the regulatory domain will also receive the completed checklist and a draft certificate and scope of accreditation from the Team leader."
QM	7.1.11 iii)	"a maximum period of 6 months" replaced by "3 months"
QM	7.1.11 v)	Added "Once accredited, the CAB can use the SANAS accreditation symbol on their reports containing accredited results."
QM	7.1.12	Added "SANAS will sample the scope of accreditation during these visits in line with the P41 "Sampling for Assessment Purposes"."
QM	8.	Title change: "Accreditation" replaced by "Scope"
QM	9.	Title added ": Re-assessment"
QM	9.1	Added completed."
QM	9.6	"pack" replaced by "information"
QM	12.	Added new section titled "Scope of Accreditation"

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